Task 3 - Fact-Finding: Questions & Interview Report

Project: Document Management System

Name	Role
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1. Purpose

This task collects facts about how documents are handled today and what users expect from the new Document Management System (DMS). The team prepared 20 questions: 10 open questions asked in an interview and 10 closed questions answered in a web form. The answers are then analysed in a short report that covers the interviewee's opinion, the interviewee's feelings, the current state of the system and the goals of the new system.

2. Team Work on This Task

Name	Part of the task	Work done
Omar Ayman	Interview and system goals	Planned the interview, asked the 10 open questions and wrote the system goals (Section 5.4).
Michael Erian	Web form and current state	Designed the web form with the 10 closed questions and prepared the current state analysis (Section 5.3).
Gamal Hamed	Notes, opinion and feelings	Recorded the interview answers, wrote the interview opinion and feelings (Sections 5.1 and 5.2) and checked the quality of the whole document.

3. Open Questions (Interview)

Open questions let the interviewee answer freely in his or her own words. The interview was held with a representative of the client organization (records / office manager). Each question below has the answer given in the interview.

No.	Open question	Answer (interview)
1	How do you store and organize your documents today?	Most documents are in paper folders and cabinets. Others are on personal computers or inside email attachments. Every person names and arranges files in his or her own way, so usually only the owner knows where a file is.
2	Describe what happens when you need to find an old document.	We ask colleagues, search the cabinets and then search old emails. It takes from several minutes to more than an hour, and sometimes the document is not found at all.
3	How do you know which version of a document is the latest?	We do not have a reliable way. People add words such as "final" or "new" to the file name, and we often call the person who edited the file to confirm.
4	What problems have you had with lost, duplicated or damaged documents?	Paper contracts have been misplaced, and the same report was saved by several people with different content. Some documents had to be written again, which wasted time and money.
5	How are important documents approved today?	The document is printed and passed by hand, or sent by email to the manager for a signature or a reply. We cannot see where the document is waiting, so approvals are often delayed.

No.	Open question	Answer (interview)
6	Who should be able to see and change documents, and how is this controlled now?	Managers should see all documents, employees should edit the documents of their own department, and some users should only read. Today control depends on locked cabinets and trust, and nobody can see who opened a file.
7	What security or privacy concerns do you have?	The documents contain private data of employees and clients. We worry about unauthorized access, a lost laptop or a file sent to the wrong person. We want to know who opened, changed or deleted each document.
8	Which features would be most useful in the new system?	Fast search, version history, permissions by user role, a simple approval process and an activity log. These match the needs listed in our system request.
9	What worries you about changing to a new system?	Some staff may find it difficult to use, the old paper documents must be scanned, and training takes time. We are afraid the system may be slow or complicated.
10	How would you measure that the new system is a success?	A document can be found in less than one minute, fewer documents are lost, less money is spent on printing and paper, and staff use the system every day after only a short training.

4. Closed Questions (Web Form)

Closed questions give a fixed list of answers (Yes/No, multiple choice or a rating scale), so the answers are quick to give and easy to count. The 10 questions below were placed in a web form for the staff of the organization. The last column shows the answer selected in the form.

No.	Closed question	Type and options	Answer (selected)
1	Where do you mostly keep your work documents?	Multiple choice: Paper folders / Personal computer / Email / Shared drive / Other	Personal computer
2	Do you sometimes spend more than 10 minutes looking for one document?	Yes / No	Yes
3	How many times in the last 6 months could a document not be found?	Multiple choice: Never / 1-2 times / 3-5 times / More than 5 times	3-5 times
4	Are you sure you are using the latest version when you open a document?	Multiple choice: Yes / Sometimes / No	Sometimes
5	Do you share documents with colleagues every week?	Yes / No	Yes
6	Which search method would you use most?	Multiple choice: Title / Category / Date / Keyword	Keyword
7	How important is it to keep old versions of a document?	Rating scale: 1 (not important) to 5 (very important)	5
8	Each user should only see the documents allowed for his or her role.	Agreement scale: Strongly agree / Agree / Disagree / Strongly disagree	Agree
9	Do you want an approval process inside the system?	Yes / No	Yes
10	How comfortable are you with using a new web-based system?	Multiple choice: Very comfortable / Comfortable / Neutral / Uncomfortable	Comfortable

5. Report

The report below is based on the 20 questions and answers in Sections 3 and 4.

5.1 Interview Opinion

The opinion of the interviewee, in short, is:

- The current way of keeping documents (paper, personal computers and email) is slow, unorganized and risky.
- A central place for all documents is needed, and fast search is the most important feature.
- Version history is needed, because nobody can be sure which file is the latest.
- Access must depend on user roles (admin, employee, viewer), and an activity log must show who opened, changed or deleted a file.
- A simple approval process will remove the delays caused by printing and passing papers.
- The system must be easy to use and staff need a short training; success means finding a document in less than one minute.

5.2 Interview Feelings

Besides the facts, the interviewee showed the following feelings while answering. They are important because they affect how the staff will accept the new system.

Feeling	Why the interviewee feels this way	Related questions
Frustration	Searching takes a long time, the latest version is never sure and documents are written again.	Open 2, 3, 4; Closed 2, 3, 4
Worry about security	Private data may be seen by the wrong person and nobody can see who opened a file.	Open 6, 7; Closed 8
Fear of change	Staff may find the system hard, scanning old papers takes effort and training takes time.	Open 9; Closed 10
Hope and support	The interviewee believes a central system will save time and money and wants to start.	Open 8, 10; Closed 7, 9

Conclusion: the strongest feelings are frustration with the present situation and hope for the new system. The fear of change is real but can be reduced with an easy interface and short training.

5.3 Current State of the System

Area	Current situation	Problem
Storage	Paper folders, personal computers and email.	No central place; files are scattered.
Searching	Asking colleagues, searching cabinets and emails.	Takes minutes to hours; some files are never found.
Versions	Names such as "final" or "new" are added to file names.	Nobody is sure which version is the latest.
Sharing	Printed copies and email attachments.	Duplicated files with different content.
Approval	Printed papers passed by hand or sent by email.	Nobody can see where the document is waiting; delays.
Security	Locked cabinets and trust between people.	No access by role and no record of who opened or changed a file.
Cost	Paper, printing, photocopying and storage cabinets (about $1,200 per year, see Lab 4).	Money is spent on paper and space, and time is lost.

5.4 System Goals

Goal	Description	How it will be measured
G1 - Central storage	Keep all documents in one secure place with folders, categories and tags.	No document is kept only on paper or on a personal computer.
G2 - Fast search	Find a document by title, category, date or keyword.	A document is found in less than one minute.
G3 - Version control	Keep old versions and show the latest one clearly.	Every change creates a version that can be opened again.
G4 - Access control	Give each user only the permissions needed (admin, employee, viewer).	Each user sees only the documents allowed for the role.
G5 - Approval workflow	Move important documents to the manager for approval inside the system.	The status of every document can be seen at any time.
G6 - Activity log	Record who opened, changed or deleted each document.	Every action is saved with the user and the time.
G7 - Ease of use	Provide a simple interface that needs little training.	Staff can use the main functions after a short training session.
G8 - Lower cost	Reduce spending on paper, printing and storage.	The administration cost of about $1,200 per year is saved.

6. Conclusion

The 20 questions show that documents are now stored in scattered places, are hard to find, have no clear versions and are not well protected. The interviewee feels frustrated by this situation, worried about security and a little afraid of change, but supports the new system. The goals in Section 5.4 agree with the business requirements in the system request (Lab 2) and will be used as the base for the requirements specification (Lab 7).